



THE 2026 TOP 10

Manufacturing ERP Systems Report

P A N O R A M A
CONSULTING GROUP

Introduction

Manufacturers are entering 2026 facing a convergence of pressures that extend well beyond traditional cost and efficiency challenges. Persistent labor shortages, regulatory changes, and accelerating AI adoption are forcing manufacturers to rethink how their core systems support decision-making at scale.

Modern manufacturing ERP platforms are now expected to support real-time visibility across plants, enable intelligent planning and execution, and integrate seamlessly with advanced technologies.

The 2026 Top 10 Manufacturing ERP Systems Report is designed to help manufacturing leaders evaluate ERP platforms through this evolving lens. Drawing on Panorama Consulting Group's hands-on experience advising manufacturers through ERP selection, and implementation, this report highlights systems that demonstrate the functional depth and long-term viability needed to support modern manufacturing.

Rather than ranking vendors, this report provides an objective overview of leading ERP solutions used by manufacturers today. It also highlights the key factors manufacturers must consider when selecting ERP systems, including AI capabilities, global operating complexity, and how ERP fits within a broader systems landscape.



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Artificial Intelligence in Action



Quick Facts

Headquarters:
Linköping, Sweden

Ownership:
Private

Founded:
1983

IFS Cloud

IFS Cloud is an industry-focused solution tailored for large and mid-sized organizations. The solution combines Enterprise Resource Planning, Service Management, and Enterprise Asset Management capabilities.

- ▶ IFS offers integrated capabilities within its cloud ERP including MES, EAM, and field service, with granular licensing.
- ▶  IFS.ai combines embedded intelligence across core operational workflows with an agentic AI strategy designed to automate, optimize, and orchestrate work across the industrial value chain.
- ▶ The system includes integrated sustainability and emissions reporting, enabling users to track environmental metrics and tie them to asset and operational data for regulatory or ESG reporting.
- ▶ IFS Cloud provides tools like Cloud Designers, IFS Connect, and an extensive API library for flexible customization and extended solution capabilities.
- ▶  IFS.ai applies governed, context-aware AI that blends deterministic rules, optimization models, and large language models, ensuring AI recommendations and autonomous actions operate within real operational constraints and enterprise control frameworks.



Quick Facts

Headquarters:
Redmond, WA

Ownership:
Public

Founded:
1975

Microsoft Dynamics 365

Microsoft Dynamics 365 offers several cloud-based ERP platforms, including a platform for Finance and a platform for Supply Chain Management, as well as functionality to support HR, project, and e-business.

- ▶ Shopfloor workers can use the Production Floor Execution (PFE) interface to run production jobs and register/adjust material consumption.
- ▶ The platform uses embedded AI to improve demand forecasting, identify supply risks, and generate actionable recommendations for planners.
- ▶ The system supports serial/batch tracking of components consumed in manufacturing, linking component IDs to finished goods directly within production workflows.
- ▶ The Traceability app enables as-built BOM (genealogy) registration, forward/backward “where-used” searches, and chain-of-custody tracking across procurement, production, and distribution.
- ▶ The system supports master planning via the Planning Optimization add-in, running planning calculations outside the core ERP/SQL database.
- ▶ The Warehouse Management mobile app runs on wrist-mounted scanning devices to support hands-free scanning and higher picking efficiency.
- ▶ Advanced Quality Management supports capabilities such as CAPA, nonconformance enhancements, electronic signatures, certificates of analysis (COAs), sampling strategies, and electronic batch records.
- ▶ The platform applies AI across production and quality processes, including predictive maintenance insights from IoT and sensor data, anomaly detection in production performance, and automated identification of quality issues.



Quick Facts

Headquarters:
Redwood City, CA

Ownership:
Public

Founded:
1977

Oracle Fusion Cloud Supply Chain & Manufacturing

Oracle Fusion Cloud is a suite of supply chain and manufacturing applications that integrates planning, execution, quality, maintenance, and financial processes within a unified cloud architecture.



▶ Native plan execution capabilities allow planned orders to be automatically released and rescheduled across connected Fusion applications.

- ▶ Supervisors can generate shift summaries using AI based on operator inputs and production data.
- ▶ The platform supports mixed-mode manufacturing, including discrete, process, lean, and project manufacturing.
- ▶ Work definitions can be configured based on product structures or process formulas, accommodating varying batch sizes, resources, and operational parameters.



▶ AI-driven features, such as Work Order Sync Assist, help synchronize engineering or work definition changes with active production orders.

- ▶ Planning Central combines demand and supply planning, enabling teams to generate forecasts, calculate safety stock, balance supply and demand, and release planned orders directly into execution workflows.



▶ In production environments, AI-enabled capabilities can assist with operational adjustments, such as reallocating work from down workstations to available resources.



Quick Facts:

Headquarters:
Waldorf, Germany

Ownership:
Public

Founded:
1972

SAP S/4HANA

SAP S/4HANA includes ready-to-run cloud ERP software for manufacturing companies. It supports all forms of both discrete and process manufacturing in a single solution, including make to stock/repetitive, make to order, configure, and engineer to order.

- ▶ Embedded Extended Warehouse Management (EWM) supports direct production integration and advanced staging patterns.
- ▶ The Manage Material Coverage Fiori app can solve supply coverage issues for materials, calculate real-time days on hand, and provide solution simulations to help solve supply chain shortages.



▶ SAP's Joule AI copilot is embedded in SAP S/4HANA Cloud Public Edition, enabling users to ask natural-language questions about production orders, material availability, delays, and KPIs, and then automatically navigate to the relevant Fiori apps and transactions.

- ▶ SAP Digital Manufacturing supports shopfloor reporting that triggers confirmations back to the ERP, supporting partial/complete confirmations, yield/scrap/rework reporting, clock in/clock out time capture, batch consumption, unplanned material additions, and synchronous goods movements.



▶ Joule AI evaluates production and supply chain exceptions by analyzing real-time operational data, summarizing likely root causes, and recommending next-best actions directly within manufacturing and supply chain workflows.



The Top 10 Manufacturing ERP Systems (Continued)

Acumatica

The Cloud ERP

Acumatica Cloud ERP

Acumatica provides a cloud-based ERP with micro-vertical functionality designed for small and mid-sized businesses. It integrates various business functions, including Financial Management, Customer Management (CRM), Manufacturing, Distribution, and more.

Quick Facts:

Headquarters:
Kirkland, WA

Ownership:
Private

Founded:
2008

- ▶ The system supports lot/serial tracking for finished goods and production processes, including preassigned lot and serial numbers and traceability throughout the item lifecycle.
- ▶ Manufacturing Data Collection uses barcodes, scanners, and mobile devices to capture material movements and labor transactions from the shop floor, updating inventory and WIP as activity occurs.
- ▶ A rules-based Product Configurator creates item-specific BOMs and routings (with calculated cost/price rollups) directly from quotes, sales orders, and production orders.
- ▶ The system supports shop-floor scheduling and work center capacity planning, including what-if planning and capable-to-promise concepts.
- ▶ Acumatica AI Studio supports configurable, no-code LLM-powered automations that can be triggered in business workflows to streamline repetitive tasks.



Deacom and M1

Deacom is a manufacturing-focused ERP system designed primarily for batch and process manufacturers. M1 is a manufacturing ERP built for complex, mixed-mode manufacturers, bringing quoting, orders, engineering, materials, and production scheduling into one flexible system.

ECI Deacom

- ▶ Real-time lot tracking and traceability allow manufacturers to monitor ingredients throughout the production process.
- ▶ End-to-end quality control enables manufacturers to establish critical checkpoints throughout production and automate testing workflows.
- ▶ Built-in compliance management tools automatically generate and manage regulatory documentation.
- ▶ Real-time accounting visibility provides finance teams with up-to-the-minute insight into costs, margins, and production variances.
- ▶ Dynamic formulation management enables on-the-fly recipe adjustments based on raw material availability, cost, or yield.

ECI M1

- ▶ Integrated quoting, estimating, and job management enable fast, accurate quotes using historical job and part data, seamless conversion into jobs with no re-entry, and end-to-end progress tracking.
- ▶ Production planning and scheduling help prioritize jobs, assign resources, and maximize throughput with drag-and-drop workflows, load balancing, what-if scenarios, and dynamic rescheduling.
- ▶ Material and inventory management provide real-time visibility into raw materials, WIP, and finished goods, while reducing carrying costs through forecasting and automated reorder alerts.
- ▶ Quality and compliance control features include inspection monitoring, nonconformance management, and full traceability to support audits.

Quick Facts

Headquarters:
Westlake, TX

Ownership:
Private

Founded:
1999

EPICOR

Quick Facts

Headquarters:
Austin, TX

Ownership:
Private

Founded:
1972

Epicor Kinetic

Epicor Kinetic is a cloud-first, modular ERP platform engineered with and for manufacturers. It unifies planning, production, supply chain, finance, and quality in a single system.

- ▶ Secure, embedded AI with Epicor Prism delivers in-context recommendations and task automation using natural language and vertical AI agents trained on manufacturing workflows.
- ▶ Epicor's manufacturing-first approach provides strong native support for discrete, mixed-mode, make-to-order, engineer-to-order, and configure-to-order manufacturing.
- ▶ Kinetic connects with Epicor MES solutions to integrate machine and operator data with ERP.
- ▶ Epicor's Connected Worker platform supports digital work instructions, real time guidance, and skills tracking, to boost agility, safety, and compliance across frontline teams.
- ▶ Kinetic integrates with Epicor solutions across PLM, CPQ, MES, Field Service, Financials, ECM, EDI, and advanced analytics, supporting the full manufacturing lifecycle, from product design to customer delivery.
- ▶ The platform is built on a secure, enterprise-grade cloud with encryption, regional hosting, and advanced access controls.



Infor CloudSuite ERPs

Infor CloudSuite ERPs for manufacturing are AI-powered and built for process and discrete manufactures to streamline and optimize complex manufacturing operations. They deliver deep industry functionality for industrial manufacturing, automotive, aerospace & defense, fashion, food & beverage, and chemical manufactures.

Quick Facts

Headquarters:
Atlanta, GA

Ownership:
Private

Founded:
2002

- ▶ The manufacturing-specific capabilities are built on manufacturing trained data models and include processes down to the micro vertical.
- ▶ Infor Industry AI is pre-built for manufacturers and delivers agents working within workflows.
- ▶ Manufacturing capabilities embed core manufacturing practices, such as bill of materials management and engineering change control, to minimize customization.
- ▶ The manufacturing suite includes centralized manufacturing systems, engineering data, and shop floor processes for end-to-end visibility and process optimization.
- ▶ Infor CloudSuite is natively built on an open, multi-tenant cloud platform and embeds technologies such as process mining, RPA, ML/AI, Agentic AI, and GenAI.
- ▶ Infor CloudSuite offers 6,000+ APIs, pre-built integrations, and extensible and secure data access with real-time insights from its own data lake and analytics tools.



ORACLE NETSUITE

NetSuite ERP

NetSuite ERP is a full suite of cloud-based ERP applications that help growing manufacturers plan, control, coordinate, and manage every aspect of their operations in one place.

- ▶ Manufacturers can use routings on work orders to define required build steps, including the work center, labor and machine resources, and costing templates used during assembly.
- ▶ NetSuite Supply Planning provides time-phased planning and MRP capabilities, including a Supply Planning Workbench and reorder-point logic that can auto-generate purchase, work, or transfer orders based on demand, safety stock, and lead times.
- ▶ The system supports demand planning at the item level to calculate and monitor demand plans used for replenishment decisions.
- ▶ NetSuite Smart Count supports cycle counting without freezing all warehouse transactions, alerts users when activity occurs during a count, and enables the cycle count process on mobile devices.
- ▶ NetSuite's Manufacturing Mobile app supports start/stop/pause labor tracking by step, can automatically relieve BOM components from inventory as production occurs, and can display work instructions to operators.

Quick Facts

Headquarters:
Austin, TX

Ownership:
Public

Founded:
1998



Quick Facts:

Headquarters:
Tel Aviv, Israel

Ownership:
Private

Founded:
1986

Priority ERP

Priority ERP is a scalable, open SaaS cloud ERP platform for organizations of all sizes. It is designed for industries such as manufacturing, wholesale and distribution, electronics, healthcare, medical devices, pharmaceutical, and more.

- ▶ Priority's comprehensive Production solution supports factory modeling (with multi-level BOMs), production planning (based on requirements from sales orders, forecast orders, safety stock, WIP, current inventory, and open purchase orders), production control, and end-to-end production traceability, including work-in-process management.
- ▶ AI capabilities are system-wide and include no-code automations (allowing users to build automations using natural language); predictive AI (via AWS's AI capabilities for forecasting and demand planning); and more.
- ▶ The system allows organizations to personalize workspaces, processes, planning parameters, and even the level of detail in routings and operations.
- ▶ The Production solution supports using subcontractors during the production process, including seamless burdening of the subcontractor's costs on the actual cost of the finished goods.
- ▶ The solution includes QA capabilities as part of the raw material receiving process and/or the production process.
- ▶ The system supports barcode-based shop floor data collection, enabling operators to report production activities, material consumption, and labor time directly from the shop floor using mobile devices.
- ▶ Priority is an open system with over 150 predefined API-based connectors and allows customers to build their own.



Honorable Mention



ArcFlow

ArcFlow differentiates itself in manufacturing ERP by being an AI-driven, cloud-based ERP that is purpose-built for small and mid-sized manufacturers and distributors. It tightly integrates production, inventory, procurement, sales, and planning in one platform using third-party finance systems. It emphasizes real-time data flow and automation across the full operational lifecycle.

Aptean



Aptean differentiates itself in manufacturing ERP by offering industry-specific, purpose-built solutions for process, formula-based, and regulated manufacturing—rather than a one-size-fits-all platform. Its ERP products emphasize built-in quality management, compliance, lot traceability, and production visibility, with preconfigured workflows aligned to specific manufacturing models.

Cetec



Cetec ERP is a cloud-native, full-suite ERP built specifically for small and mid-sized manufacturers and distributors. It offers integrated modules for production planning, MRP, inventory control, quality management, CRM, shop-floor tracking, accounting, and more, all in a single platform. The platform provides real-time visibility and traceability across operations without relying on disconnected tools. It's known for affordable, transparent pricing, rapid implementation, and strong in-house support.

QAD



QAD differentiates itself in manufacturing ERP by being a deeply manufacturing-centric, adaptive platform built for global and regulated manufacturers—rather than a generalist ERP. QAD's Adaptive ERP is designed specifically for complex manufacturing and supply chain operations across industries like automotive, life sciences, food & beverage, and industrial equipment, with strong support for production planning, scheduling, inventory, traceability, and quality management.

Unit4



Unit4 differentiates itself by focusing on people-centric, project-driven manufacturing and asset-intensive organizations. Its cloud ERP is particularly well suited for manufacturers with strong project management, engineering, and service components, such as engineer-to-order, capital projects, and hybrid manufacturing-service models. Unit4 emphasizes flexible financial management, project accounting, and resource planning, with embedded automation and AI designed to reduce administrative effort.

Generative AI vs. Operational AI

Not all types of AI serve the same purpose or carry the same risk. In particular, manufacturers must clearly distinguish between generative AI and operational AI (predictive analytics and ML used for execution decisions).

Generative AI

This type of AI is designed to create new content and synthesize information.

In manufacturing ERP systems, this often appears as AI copilots that draft reports, summarize production data, generate work instructions, and assist engineers with documentation and design concepts.

These capabilities can meaningfully reduce administrative burden, accelerate engineering cycles, and improve access to institutional knowledge.

For example, generative AI can help supervisors quickly understand shift performance by summarizing manufacturing execution system (MES) data or assist planners by translating complex supply chain scenarios into plain-language insights.

Operational AI

This type of AI focuses on execution-critical decisions.

In manufacturing ERP systems, operational AI can assist with predictive maintenance, demand forecasting, production scheduling, quality inspection, and inventory optimization. Here, explainability and reliability are often more important than creativity.

For example, a scheduling algorithm that optimizes machine utilization or a predictive model that flags equipment failure must be auditable, traceable, and trusted by frontline teams.

This means operational AI capabilities must be engineered for reliability through governed data pipelines, constraints/thresholds, validation, monitoring, and audit trails.

When Organizations Misunderstand the Difference

The risk arises when generative AI is positioned as a replacement for operational decision-making on the shop floor.

While generative models can provide recommendations or contextual guidance, they are not inherently designed to guarantee consistency or compliance. In fact, in high-volume or regulated manufacturing environments, over-automating production decisions with generative AI can introduce variability, increase quality risk, and erode operator trust.

To mitigate generative AI risks, we recommend establishing human-in-the-loop approvals while also relying on RAG (retrieval augmented generation) to ground responses in specific sources.

Yet, operational AI should remain the backbone of planning, execution, and control, where decisions must be predictable and defensible.

ERP Selection Tips for Multi-Plant and Global Manufacturing Complexity

While many ERP vendors claim to support global manufacturing, the realities of multi-plant manufacturing frequently reveal gaps between system features and practical execution. These gaps typically emerge as structural challenges that affect how organizations standardize processes, manage compliance, and coordinate operations across plants and regions.

Common challenges include:

1. Balancing Global Standardization With Local Autonomy

Corporate leaders often prioritize global ERP templates to streamline reporting, reduce IT complexity, and enable shared services. This can conflict with the fact that individual plants often operate under different labor rules, tax structures, regulatory requirements, and production constraints.

An ERP system that enforces excessive standardization can limit plant-level responsiveness, while too much flexibility can fragment data and processes.

Modern manufacturing ERP systems attempt to address this challenge through multi-entity architectures that support shared master data alongside localized configurations. Yet, it is up to the organization to decide which processes should be globally consistent and which should remain plant specific.

2. Navigating Regulatory and Compliance Complexity

Global manufacturers must manage varying requirements for financial reporting, product traceability, environmental compliance, and labor laws.

ERP systems that lack robust localization capabilities often force organizations into costly workarounds or parallel systems. Over time, this undermines data integrity, making it harder for leaders to respond quickly to disruptions or ensure compliance across plants and regions.

3. Managing Inter-Plant Coordination

Multi-plant manufacturers frequently share production loads, transfer inventory between facilities, and reallocate capacity in response to demand shifts.

Manufacturing ERP systems must support accurate intercompany transactions, real-time inventory visibility, and coordinated planning across sites. When these capabilities are weak or inconsistently implemented, planners may resort to spreadsheets and manual reconciliation.



Conclusion

For manufacturers evaluating ERP systems in 2026, it's important to align ERP selection decisions with long-term strategies, whether this includes multi-plant expansion or AI adoption across planning and production environments.

Panorama Consulting Group remains committed to providing objective, technology-agnostic support to manufacturers navigating selection decisions. Our independent ERP guidance can help you define specific requirements and assess your AI readiness. Contact us below to connect with Panorama's ERP and AI experts.

Click the Button Below to Schedule Your **Free Consultation**
With an ERP Systems Expert Today!

FREE CONSULTATION

About Panorama Consulting Group

Panorama Consulting Group is an independent, niche consulting firm specializing in business transformation and ERP system implementations for mid- to large-sized private- and public-sector organizations worldwide. One-hundred percent technology agnostic and independent of vendor affiliation, Panorama offers a phased, top-down strategic alignment approach and a bottom-up tactical approach, enabling each client to achieve its unique business transformation objectives by transforming its people, processes and technology.

Panorama's Services

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- ▶ [Supply Chain Management](#)
- ▶ [ERP Implementation](#)
- ▶ [Organizational Change Management](#)
- ▶ [ERP Contract Negotiation](#)
- ▶ [Business Process Management](#)
- ▶ [Cloud Migration](#)
- ▶ [M&A Integration](#)
- ▶ [Digital Strategy](#)
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- ▶ [AI Readiness and Enablement](#)
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